

Spiritual Formation





About the Course

Spiritual formation courses help students think more deeply about various topics in the Christian life such as prayer, studying the Bible, and other spiritual disciplines.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 7-8



Placement & Combining Tips

Also appropriate for HS students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	Transformed by Truth This Changes Everything

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 7-8				
Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 7-8	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8



Transformed by Truth



This Changes Everything



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

Read the commentary to prepare.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)



Introduce

Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

Read aloud from the Bible.



Narrate

Have the students narrate.



Share

Optional: Share something interesting from your preparation that will help shed light on the story.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ INTRO

How would you answer someone who asks why you study the Bible? As the title indicates, the first half of Transformed by Truth will focus on the why of studying the Bible, while the second half will move into the how of Bible study. As we move through the book's second half, we will apply the lessons to a chapter from your reading in the book of Acts.

→ READ & NARRATE

Intro p.13-16

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to reflect on the author's statement, "Teens need serious Bible study just as much as adults." Do you agree? Why or why not? What do you hope to learn about Bible study this year?

WEEK 2 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.1 p.19-29

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more of the questions on p.29 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 3 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

Part of Bible study starts with basic questions, such as, "What does the Bible say about this matter?" Rather than taking an author's opinion or statement as truth when claiming the Bible supports it, verifying and reading what the Bible says on the subject is important. As you read through Transformed by Truth, look up the Scripture references that are included as time allows. Today, those verses are assigned as part of the reading.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.31-36 "When I was" - "others. Praise God!"

Also read the verses in the passage: Jer. 1:1-2; Ezek. 1:3; 2 Pet. 1:20-21; 2

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

Pet. 3:15-16; 2 Tim. 3:16; 1 Cor. 7:40

- Did reading the verses from the source (the Bible) help clarify or support the author's claim?

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to record new insights, copy quotes, or ask questions.

WEEK 4 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.36-44 "The Bible's Books" - "the next chapter."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more of the questions on p.44 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 5 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

You may have heard the Bible called The Greatest Story Ever Told. In today's reading, the author describes different elements of a story - elements you have most likely learned about in literature classes, but have you ever applied that framework to the Story of Scripture?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.45-51 "The Bible has" - "all the others."

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to record new insights, copy quotes, or ask questions. Using the elements the author is explaining, begin a diagram or chart of the Story of Scripture (you'll continue it in the second half of the chapter).

WEEK 6 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.52-56 "Most epic fantasies" - "only the beginning."

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Term 1

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more of the questions on p.56 to answer in your notebook. Complete the diagram you began last week of the Story of Scripture. As the author mentions on p.55, mark where you are in the story (by drawing a stick figure, writing your name, or marking it however you want to signify YOU!). Copy Acts 1:8 into the chart above where you are marked. From your reading in Acts and the ideas presented in this chapter about the Story of Scripture, what would you say your mission is as a believer in the Lord?

WEEK 7 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.57-64 "God's will for" - "faith? Do we?"

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to record new insights, copy quotes, or ask questions.

WEEK 8 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.64-72 "While Moses was" - "the next chapter."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more questions to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 9 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.73-79 "God's word commands" - "him will grow."

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to record new insights, copy quotes, or ask questions.

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 10 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.79-84 "We saw earlier" - "transformed by truth."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more questions to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 11 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Materials: Linked article

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

As the author has discussed, part of studying the Bible is understanding the "Big Story" of the Bible and its metanarrative. What does it mean for the Bible to be read as literature? Instead of God giving us a bullet-point list of attributes about who he is and what he is like, he shows us his character through the stories of how he interacted with people. Just as fictional stories use different elements such as characters, setting, plot, climax, and resolution to tell a good story, the Bible uses the same elements to tell the true stories of God's people. When we understand these elements better, we can understand the Bible better. "A book needs to be read in keeping with its author's intention. We can see from the Bible itself that it is a thoroughly literary book. God superintended its authors to write a very (though not wholly) literary book. Paying adequate attention to the literary qualities of the Bible not only helps to unlock the meanings of the Bible; it is also a way of honoring the literary intentions of its authors. Surely, biblical authors regarded everything they put into their writing as important. We also need to regard those things as important." (How Bible Stories Work, p.10) This quote is from Leland Ryken, a retired professor and author. Today's reading is an article Ryken wrote about reading the Bible as literature.

→ READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: Ten Things You Should Know About the Bible as Literature

→ NOTEBOOK

Add any notes, thoughts, or questions about the article in your notebook.

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Term 1

WEEK 12 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

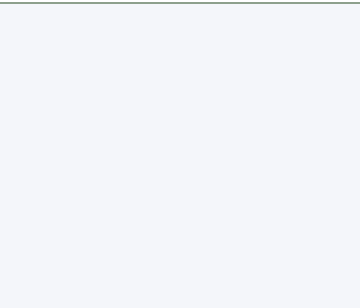
Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Transformed by Truth



Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 1 ☐ 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

☐ Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

As we move into the second half of Transformed by Truth, we will look at the *how* of Bible study.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.87-99 "What's the right" - "about our God."

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer the three questions on p.99.

WEEK 2 ☐ 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

☐ Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.101-107 "I know I" - "to give it."

→ NOTEBOOK

List the three pillars of inductive Bible study. Write down any quotes, phrases, or ideas that stand out from the reading.

WEEK 3 ☐ 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

☐ Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook, Bible study supplies as needed (see below)

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.108-112 "The first step" - "of a masterpiece."

As you read, jot down what the author recommends for supplies for Bible study. Gather these supplies and print out Acts 17 for your inductive Bible study. (If you want the chapter to be double-spaced as the author recommends, you will need to copy and paste the chapter into a separate document to adjust the line spacing there.)

∞ Link: Acts 17 (ESV)

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer the three questions on p.112.

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 4 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.8 p.113-124

(Instead of studying 3 John as the author suggests, we will study Acts 17 to go along with your New Testament reading beginning in the next lesson.)

→ NOTEBOOK

Take notes on today's reading of chapter 8. Note the three types of context and what is included in each.

WEEK 5 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

In today's lesson, we will apply the information from chapter 8 of Transformed by Truth to our study in Acts.

→ READ

Using at least two different resources, look up and read an introduction to Acts to find information about the Historical, Biblical, and Cultural context of Acts. The Ultimate Bible Atlas, The Chronological Guide to the Bible, and the ESV Concise Study Bible you use in your Bible reading all contain contextual background information. Alternatively, you could use an online site such as Bible Project or Blue Letter Bible, or ask a parent what Bible commentaries or Bible dictionaries they may have that could be used.

∞ Link: Blue Letter Bible (click on Tools for commentaries)

∞ Link: The Bible Project

→ NOTEBOOK

From your reading of two different resources, write three facts or points under each of the three types of context (Biblical, Historical, Cultural). (e.g., under Historical Context, you could write the date range of the acts that were written.)

WEEK 6 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

→ READ

p.125-132 "When I was" - "to them soon!"

Take notes as you read about what questions are being answered when you look at the bigger picture or "airplane window view," and then the close-up picture or the "walking the streets" view.

→ NOTEBOOK

Using your notes on your reading, apply these questions to Acts as a whole (you have already done some, if not all, of this in the last lesson and in your reading of Acts).

Next, use your Acts 17 printout to answer the chapter's six close-up view questions (who, what, when, where, why, how).

WEEK 7 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.132-140 "Now that we're" - "study so far."

Take notes as you read.

→ NOTEBOOK

Using your Acts 17 printout, do the following:

- Read through Acts 17 looking for repeated words, themes, or phrases. Some examples are given below, but if you find any others on your own, mark those.
- Mark all words related to thinking, studying, and reasoning (synonyms or antonyms) in red.
- Mark all cities Paul travels to in green.
- Mark all names of people mentioned in brown.
- Mark any reactions of people listening to the message Paul is preaching in blue. Is there a difference in reactions from different groups or individuals?
- If you find any other themes you want to mark, do so now. Ideas might include action words (persuaded, joined, attacked, etc.), responses from women, or words referring to or having to do with God (Lord, word of God, etc.).
- What is the main issue that is making the people angry?

WEEK 8 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.141-146 "What do you" - "makes it interpretation."

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

→ NOTEBOOK

1. Using the author's example on p.145, write a summary (paraphrase) of Acts 17. For instance, your first point might read: Paul and Silas arrive in Thessalonica, where Paul teaches in the synagogue (vs.1-3).
2. Keeping in mind the main idea of Acts, which shows the growth of the early church, how does Acts 17 fit into the flow of the book? How does what Luke includes in his synopsis of events help support his main purpose in writing Acts?

WEEK 9 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.146-155 "The heart of" - "the next chapter."

(Use the questions below as we focus on Acts 17, instead of the book's questions.)

→ NOTEBOOK

1. Read Acts 17 again. Read Paul's sermon in verses 22-31 again. Why does Paul focus on idols in his message? What had the philosophers (such as the Epicureans and Stoics) made an idol of?
2. Look up the following cross-references for "philosophers" and write down any observations you may have: 1 Corinthians 1:20-21; Romans 1:22; Colossians 2:6-8.
3. Pick another verse or passage from Acts 17 that you would like to study more closely. Use a Bible Dictionary, or footnotes in a Study Bible, to research the passage's meaning. (Blueletterbible.org links to study notes or dictionaries if you cannot access one.) Write observations in your notebook.
∞ Link: Blue Letter Bible
4. Use either the online Blue Letter Bible or a Strong's Concordance to look up the Strong's number, Greek word, and definition for the word "babbler" found in Acts 17:18.
5. Using a commentary from your home, church, or library, look up the passage and write down any notes about what you learn about the passage. (Blueletterbible.org also has links to commentaries.)

WEEK 10 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.157-168 "Can you imagine" - "and forevermore. Amen."

→ NOTEBOOK

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

Answer the questions regarding the application on p.168 (based on Acts 17).
Choose a verse or a short passage from Acts 17 to memorize if you would like.

WEEK 11 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

While you have reached the end of Transformed by Truth, what you have learned can be used to study any passage of the Bible. As you continue reading the book of Acts, remember the specific things you have learned from chapter 17 and apply that to the bigger context of Acts and, ultimately, to the overarching context of the entire Bible.

→ READ & NARRATE

Appendix B: Memorization Tips and Helps p.177-180

- Continue working on the verse or passage you have chosen to memorize from Acts 17.

→ NOTEBOOK

Create a worksheet or outline highlighting the key points from Transformed by Truth about the how and why of Bible study. What information would you include if you were teaching a class about inductive Bible study?

WEEK 12 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Transformed by Truth

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the overall message of Transformed by Truth?

→ INTRO

In this lesson, we will begin the book *This Changes Everything: How the Gospel Transforms the Teen Years*. The author states in her intro that this book is for young people who want to grow in their spiritual life. "...Because we love Jesus. If we love Jesus, we'll love truth, and we'll want to grow" (p.14). And - as the title states - the author shows how the gospel changes our entire life and touches every area of our existence.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.1 p.17-29

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions on p.29 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 2 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time about how the gospel changes our identity?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.2 p.31-42

- Toward the beginning of the year, lessons 5 and 6 covered the chapter in *Transformed by Truth* that focused on the Story of the Bible. Today's reading also covered the subject. Why is it good to be reminded of the overarching story of the Bible? Are you able to see yourself as part of that story? Why or why not? Is there any part of this subject you think the authors missed in their chapters?

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions from p.42-43 and answer them in your notebook.

WEEK 3 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time about the story of the Bible?

• EXTRA HELPING

View the video at the link where Bible teacher Mike Winger goes through Eight Reasons God Wants You to Go to Church. Write the reasons and excuses he gives and then write a short response in your notebook.

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ INTRO

Would you consider yourself an introvert or an extrovert? Maybe the word "community" is a bit intimidating! Today's chapter is about how the gospel affects our relationship with the people in our church. And thankfully, there's space for both introverts and extroverts!

→ READ & NARRATE

p.45-56 "The gospel is" - "change anybody's life."

→ NOTEBOOK

The author points out that part of loving your church is praying for those who are in it. Create a prayer list or write out a prayer for people - leaders, friends, other families, or kids your age - in your church. Write out any other responses or thoughts about the author's points about community.

∞ **Video Link:** 8 Reasons God Wants You to Go to Church

WEEK 4 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

 Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.57-67 "So make your" - "We are free."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions on p.62 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 5 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

 Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.67-77 "But even though" - "break his promises."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions listed to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 6 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

 Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.79-89 "Let's pretend there" - "our prayer life."

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ NOTEBOOK

Take some time to consider the following questions, and write out your thoughts or answers in your notebook: Do you think of the word "discipline" in a positive or negative way? Or does it depend on the context? What spiritual disciplines have you implemented in your life? What spiritual discipline(s) would you like to focus on? Write out a prayer asking the Lord for help in doing so.

WEEK 7 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.89-95 "Only recently have" - "our evangelizing: Jesus."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions from p.95-96 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 8 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.6 p.97-110

- Did you notice C.H. Spurgeon's quote about books in today's reading? What have you learned about Spurgeon that would show he agrees with the author's main point of the book, which is that the gospel changes everything in life? How did Spurgeon himself live out a life that would support that point?

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer question #1 on p.110 (because Spurgeon!) and choose either question 2 or 3 on p.111 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 9 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.7 p.113-126

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions on p.127 to consider and answer in your notebook.

WEEK 10 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

 Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.129-138 "Throughout this book" - "and love them."

→ READ

∞ Article Link: William Wilberforce and His Circle of Friends

Beginning at the fourth paragraph (which begins with "Throughout history"), read the linked article to learn about William Wilberforce's group of friends who supported his efforts and encouraged him as a community around him. This reading can be split between this and next week if needed.

- How does the description of the group of friends around Wilberforce align with what has been presented in this book as far as how the gospel affects our relationships is concerned? How did these friends encourage each other in their spiritual lives?

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer question #2 on p.146 in your notebook. Write out a prayer asking the Lord to help you in your relationships with others, whether that is a friend, a parent, a sibling, or someone else.

WEEK 11 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

 Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.138-148 "Siblings are a" - "live like it."

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer questions #1 and #3 on p.145-146 in your notebook. Write down any final thoughts about this book.

WEEK 12 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: This Changes Everything

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

- Transformed by Truth: Explain how the Bible is a "Big Story." What elements of story do we see in the Bible? Give examples of those elements from the Bible story.
- Transformed by Truth: Give two of the reasons the Bible should be studied, along with explanations of those reasons.

Term 2

- Transformed by Truth: What are the three steps of inductive Bible study? Explain what each step involves.
- Transformed by Truth: How would you go about studying a chapter of the Bible?

Term 3

- This Changes Everything: How has the author supported her point that "why who we are influences what we do"? Name two areas the gospel affects in our lives, and how what we do changes in those areas because of who we are in Christ.
- This Changes Everything: In what ways does the gospel affect how we relate to the church? What are some ways the author states a believer is called to support the church?